

Travel Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy defines the rules and entitlements for employees undertaking official business travel, domestic or international, on behalf of TCS.

2. Scope

Applies to all employees traveling for business purposes such as client visits, conferences, or inter-office meetings.

3. Definitions

Travel Authorization (TA)	A pre-approved request required before booking any business travel.
Daily Allowance (DA) / Per Diem	A fixed daily amount to cover incidental expenses while traveling.

4. Domestic Travel

Domestic business travel must be booked at least 5 working days in advance where possible, through the company's approved travel booking portal (TravelDesk). Grades T1–M2 travel by AC 2-Tier train or economy flight for journeys over 500 km; grades M3 and above (Senior Manager and up) may book business-class rail or, for flights over 3 hours, premium economy.

5. International Travel

International travel requires Vice President-level approval in addition to the standard Travel Authorization, and must be initiated at least 3 weeks in advance to allow for visa processing. Economy class is standard for flights under 6 hours; premium economy is permitted for flights exceeding 6 hours. Business class requires CXO approval and is generally limited to Director-level and above.

6. Travel Authorization

All business travel, domestic or international, requires a **Travel Authorization (TA)** raised on the employee portal before any booking is made, specifying purpose, destination, dates, and estimated cost. The TA must be approved by the Reporting Manager (and additional approvers for international travel) before tickets are booked.

7. Flight / Train Booking

All flight and train bookings must be made through the TravelDesk portal or the designated corporate travel agent, not directly by the employee, to ensure negotiated corporate rates and duty-of-care tracking. Self-booked travel is reimbursed only in exceptional circumstances with prior Finance approval, and capped at the equivalent TravelDesk fare.

8. Hotel Booking

Hotel accommodation is booked via TravelDesk within the applicable city-wise cap: ■6,000/night for metro cities (Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, Chennai) and ■4,500/night for other cities, inclusive of taxes. Employees may choose a higher-tier hotel at their own cost for the difference.

9. Transportation

Local transportation during business travel (airport transfers, client-site commute) should use company-empanelled cab services where available, or reimbursable metered taxi/ride-hailing services, per the Expense Reimbursement Policy (TCS-FIN-002).

10. Daily Allowances

Employees traveling domestically receive a Daily Allowance of ■1,500/day for metro cities and ■1,200/day for other cities, to cover incidental expenses (local transport, tips, and sundries) not separately reimbursed. International Daily Allowance is set per destination country and published in the Travel Rate Card on the Finance intranet page.

11. Meals

Meal expenses during travel are covered either through the Daily Allowance (domestic) or through itemized reimbursement with receipts (international), up to the caps defined in the Travel Rate Card. Client-hosted meals should not be separately claimed.

12. Travel Class

Travel class entitlements by grade are summarized in the table below.

13. Travel Advance

Employees may request a travel advance of up to 80% of the estimated trip cost via the TravelDesk portal, disbursed at least 2 working days before departure. The advance must be reconciled against actual expenses within 7 working days of return, per the Expense Reimbursement Policy (TCS-FIN-002).

14. Travel Cancellation

If a trip is cancelled after booking, the employee must notify TravelDesk immediately to minimize cancellation fees. Cancellation charges are borne by the company if the cancellation is business-driven (e.g., client reschedules); charges arising from personal reasons or late notice by the employee may be recovered from the employee, at management discretion.

15. Required Documents

For international travel, employees must ensure a passport valid for at least 6 months beyond the return date, and must submit visa application documents through the Global Mobility team. All travel-related receipts (boarding passes, hotel invoices, taxi receipts) must be retained and uploaded during expense reconciliation.

16. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What expenses are covered during business travel?

A: Flights/trains, hotel accommodation (within city-wise caps), local transportation, a Daily Allowance for incidentals, and meals, all booked or claimed as outlined in this policy and the Expense Reimbursement Policy (TCS-FIN-002).

Q: Do I need approval before booking a flight?

A: Yes. A Travel Authorization must be raised and approved on the employee portal before any booking is made. International travel additionally requires Vice President-level approval.

Q: Who approves business travel?

A: The Reporting Manager approves domestic Travel Authorizations. International travel requires additional Vice President approval, and business-class international travel requires CXO approval.

17. Contact Information

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